

## MYLAPORE

Mandaveli » R A Puram » Royapettah » Chindatripet » Royapuram » Korukkupet » Ennore » Luz » Alwarpet » Triplicane » Central

Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur



Members of Poonga View RWA which represents TP Scheme Road in Mandaveli have a request for CM Vijay

The squalor marking one side of TP Scheme Road.  
PHOTOS: PRINCE FREDERICK



## Not the view they had bargained for

PRINCE FREDERICK

**P**oonga View Residents Welfare Association: when they christened their RWA thus, residents of TP Scheme Road in Mandaveli had in mind categories of “views” diametrically opposite to what they are being treated to.

TP Scheme Road is 300 metres long, and one side of the road has a wall, one bounding the Adyar Poonga. It means there are habitations on only one side of the road.

A careless count puts it at 50; sparsely populated, one would expect serenity. And nature rearing up on one side meant the eyes have a pleasant object to focus on.

Here are the categories of “views” they are actually treated to on a daily basis, as listed by members of Poonga View RWA. Open urination along the wall. Unauthorised parking along the wall. When the TASMAR outlet was on Venkatarishna Road in Mandaveli, tipplers would turn the space by the

wall into an open bar, and some of them would make it a “bed” for a stupefied, post-alcohol slumber. As reported by residents, there would also be other forms of substance abuse behind the illegally parked vehicles, some of them abandoned. Couples would also arrive in cars. Besides, the trees in the Poonga that were expected to give them a pleasant view, would ironically add to the problems. The leaves they shed, along with those shrugged off by the avenue trees on

TP Scheme Road, would accumulate by the side of the wall, as parked vehicles would mean the Urbaser Summit workers cannot clear the putrefying muck. There would be garbage as well, according to a member of the RWA. Reptiles feel at home in this muck.

This road falls in ward 171, Zone 13, and these residents have taken the matter to the councillor, and earlier even escalated it to the previous MLA.

And they are still waiting for all

these problems to be resolved.

This is how a member of Poonga View RWA puts it: “This has been the scene for many years with no action taken by the government even after many complaints to Greater Chennai Corporation. They keep pointing at the other officials for not doing their job. We want to bring this to the notice of CM Vijay so that there will be some action by the new government that could solve our long-pending problems.”



## Barricades to prevent parking on Kalvivaaru Street

Chennai City Traffic Police has erected barricades along Kalvivaaru Street in Mylapore as many cars were illegally parked on the stretch. For the last few days, this arrangement has helped. Since the schools are going to reopen in a fortnight one expects this to be helpful. Also, this stretch is used by motorists to head to Royapettah High Road and Kutcheri Road.

TEXT AND PHOTO BASKAR SESHADRI



Recycling drive in RK Nagar and Mandaveli Raja Street draws participation from various other parts of Chennai including Anna Nagar, Velachery and Adyar

## Communities unite for resource revival



Recyclable waste being unloaded from cars and lined up. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

GANGA SRIDHAR

On May 17, Team EcoKonnectors's much-awaited Resource Revival Drive unfolded at sections of Mandaveli and R.A. Puram. Recycling partner Spreco shored up the exercise, which received generous buy-in from the communities of RK Nagar, Mandaveli Raja Street RWA, Ragamallika and Poonga View RWA.

The one-day drive, which was flagged off around 10 a.m. at RK Nagar and Mandaveli Raja Street, saw people thronging in cars

loaded with things to give away, coming from far-off places such as Velachery, Anna Nagar, Teynampet and areas around Mylapore, Mandaveli, R.A. Puram, Abhiramapuram and Adyar.

A few communities collected items within their apartments and sent their contributions through one of their residents.

Volunteers who dared the *Kathri Veyiyil* (peak summer heat) to support the collection points were elated to see the kind of response from people and the enquiries about when the next drive would be held.

The vacation time was put to

best use, with many children participating in the drive and helping in the decluttering of their houses. Children from Raja Street and RK Nagar also participated in creating awareness videos to spread the message about the drive through social media platforms.

People used this opportunity to give away their hardly-used pre-loved belongings and what they considered waste.

The old clothes collected during the drive were sent to the textile recovery facility of Spreco, where they will be given a fresh lease of life.

Other resources such as plastics, metal, e-waste, thermocol and paper were sent to the Material Recovery Facility, from where they will be sent for recycling; the end result being that the resource value of waste is revived and its entry into dumping grounds is delayed.

Together, three truckloads of resources were sent for revival.

### Waste Tour

Volunteers at the drop points made sure everyone who came felt good about being part of the drive by explaining where their waste went and how it was revived.

### Quiz for middle-school students

Chennai-based KSA Trust is inviting school teams for the second edition of 'Quiz Champions of Chennai - 2026'. Curated by expert quiz masters, this event is designed to educate and engage middle-school students by sharing champion stories and diverse areas of knowledge.

The 2025 event had 28 schools and 1,550 students participating in it. Winners received certificates, gift vouchers, and a plaque for their school.

Founded by the 30-year-old Chennai-based Chartered Accounting firm Kalyanasundaram Associates, since 2013 KSA Trust has been running its annual 'Champions of Chennai Awards', where it honour individuals and organisations in Chennai who have made remarkable contributions across fields such as arts, education, healthcare, enterprise, social initiative, science, and sports. These are people who serve selflessly, often without recognition, yet profoundly impact our community, said a release.

It has recognised 77 such champions to date, and August 17, 2026, will mark its 13th year, added the release.

To learn more, please visit: [www.championsofchennai.org](http://www.championsofchennai.org)

For any questions regarding the quiz, email [rao@championsofchennai.org](mailto:rao@championsofchennai.org) or call 98411 16216.

### Free workshop on postcard writing

The Madras Postcrossing Commune is conducting a free training workshop on postcard writing on May 24 at the premises of Kin Technologies, Anna Salai; from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m.

During this workshop, the art of postcard writing including its significance and practical methods of usage will be explained in detail. The organisers intend to raise awareness regarding 'World Turtle Day' (May 23) by releasing a special postcard.

There is no age limit for participating in this workshop. Prior registration is mandatory to participate in the workshop. To register or for further details, contact 7448523232 or 8667494269.

The Madras Postcrossing Commune is a voluntary organisation dedicated to promoting the practice of postcard writing.





# Grievance list handed to Mylapore MLA

In a late evening meeting with P. Venkataramanan, Raja Street residents raise three issues: spurt in thefts, dangerously dangling internet cables and speeding in accident-prone areas



**M**embers of Mandaveli Raja Street Residents Welfare Association met P. Venkataramanan, Mylapore MLA and Tamil Nadu Food and Civil Supplies Minister on the evening of May 20 to congratulate him on his electoral victory and submit a representation highlighting civic and

law-and-order concerns in the locality.

A press release notes the residents described the interaction with the Mylapore MLA as “productive” and appreciated his willingness to engage with the public late into the night.

“We were happy to meet an energetic, action-oriented re-

presentative. Even at 9.30 p.m., he was fully charged to meet us, go through the request letter handed over by us and note every point raised,” a resident said.

The residents also thanked the Minister for facilitating the closure of the TASMAL outlet on Venkatakrishna Road in

Mandaveli, which they said had caused inconvenience and disturbances to the neighbourhood for a long time.

Among the key issues raised during the meeting were the spurt in thefts around Raja Street and alleged anti-social activities in the TP Scheme Road area. The Association also

sought measures to address the issue of haphazardly hanging low-level internet cables, which residents said posed a risk to motorists and pedestrians.

Installation of speed breakers in accident-prone stretches was another major demand placed before the Minister, the release added.

## RAPRA Kids Club out of the blocks

Offered free, the club operates on a mentorship model with volunteers being roped in to sustain it

**R**APRA Kids Club (RKC), an initiative by Raja Annamalai Puram Residents Association (RAPRA) has gone on steam.

RKC is not a summer club; nor a hobby club. It is a free initiative envisioned by Dr. Chandrasekharan to instil moral values, life skills and social awareness in children, says a RAPRA press release.

The club aims to shape confident, responsible and empathetic young citizens through fun and real-world activities. A vibrant team of teachers, storytellers, artists, counsellors, civic & environmental experts and together with a few RAPRA EC members are RKC mentors who power the sessions, the release adds.

The club meets every fortnight, on a Saturday evening, offering regular engagement while ensuring it is not another school-like experience, but rather a space where children explore lessons and values rarely taught in classrooms.



The first session on April 25, 2026 began with a traditional Villu Paattu by the mentors heralding the inauguration of RKC and introducing themselves.

An understanding of the world around them and psycho-social health are imparted to them through special observances. The May theme highlights gratitude to mother, as Mother's Day falls in the month. With Earth Day in April, the theme for that month was greenery and energy conservation.

Children are encouraged to express themselves through art, music and storytelling. The sessions are designed to make children speak out, share ideas, and grow socially aware. RKC is not just a club—it is a movement to nurture future changemakers. The club aims to sow seeds of values, creativity and civic responsibility in young minds. For free registration, call 9176545899.





This facility is a boon to women from many an interior street in Chintadripet. PHOTOS. RAGU R

R. RAGU

**A**t this community gymnasium in Chintadripet for women, functionality pulls its weight. Luxury does not quite keep pace with functionality, but no one is complaining.

With murals displaying women in workouts, the ambience draws the eye without going over the top. Though compact, the gym comes with sufficient space, further enhanced by a mirror, not one stretching from roof to floor, the kind encountered at every turn in commercial gyms, but large enough to provide a sense of expansiveness. The flooring seems to have been designed for safety, being slip-resistant. Being seating-based, the fitness work station is suitable even for elderly users. Among the notable fitness equipment are stationary exercise bikes, an elliptical cross-trainer and a cable machine.

And one look at the composition of the people visiting this Greater Chennai Corporation-run, women's gym at Vedagiri Street in Chintadripet, and the question of inclusivity gets decisively settled. The age band of the visitors is wide; there are home makers whose day never gets done; the elderly, who have settled into quiet retirement; and even working women, who troop into the gym in the early opening hours, spend a few minutes for fitness and rush back home to get ready for office.

Gyms always provide a space for banter; but this one specialises in neighbourhood banter. Freezing one frame, this photo-journalist got to interact with three women who were from the streets that are neighbours to Ve-

## Women pump iron in Chintadripet

The women-centric gym at Vedagiri Street is enjoying steady patronage. Currently operational only in the morning hours, it is expected to help a greater number of working women when its doors stay open in the evening as well



dagiri Street. Vineetha (aged 46), a resident of Iyya Street. Jennifer (aged 31), a resident of Padavat-tamman Street. Sonam, also 31 years old and staying at Padavat-tamman Street, is visiting her parents, long-time residents of that street in Chintadripet.

This gym is turning out to be a valued community facility for women residents across the neighbourhood, enabling them to take fewer steps to access a fitness space, but cover considerable ground in terms of good health. Located in Ward 62 which comes under Royapuram Zone of Greater Chennai Corporation, the gym's establishment was made possible by funds from the coun-



cillor's allocation. The total cost of project is ₹46 lakh.

At present, the facility operates from 6.30 a.m. to 10.30 a.m.; evening hours are expected to be

introduced in the future, expanding access for working women and students.

The gym is now being managed temporarily by Corporation

staff member Muthamma. After completing her morning responsibilities at the gym, she continues her work day at the ward office. This arrangement would be in place till the appointment of a full-time caretaker. When that happens, the gym's doors would be open in the evening hours too.

On an average, 15 women would be using the facility every day, visiting at timings convenient to them.

The gym has filled an important gap by offering an accessible and private space for exercise in the neighbourhood.

Vineetha says women in the area had earlier depended largely on walking at May Day Park for physical activity.

Jennifer notes the gym had added variety to their routines. "Usually, we were only walking. Stationary cycling brings an air of novelty to our exercise routine," she elaborates.

She adds that exercising outdoors often required residents to begin early in the morning before the heat intensified. "Walking in May Day Park would require us to head there early before the sun gets intense. The gym gives us the option of exercising a little later in the day. There is also privacy here," Jennifer points out.

Sonam, from Coimbatore and currently visiting her parents at Padavat-tamman Street, observes the facility has enabled her to maintain continuity in her regular fitness regimen. "In Coimbatore, I would hit the gym regularly. Quick access to this facility means there is continuity to my fitness routine," notes Sonam.

The gym will see wider operations once evening operations begin, especially among working women unable to visit during morning hours.



Residents losing property or educational documents face protracted bureaucratic procedures before securing non-traceable certificates required for getting duplicate copies

LIFFY THOMAS

**I**n Chennai, 20-25 Non-Traceable Certificates are issued a month by the Police Department, the list generally released on Thursdays. Sought by those who have lost any original property-related document or misplaced an educational certificate that cannot be traced, getting a Non-Traceable Certificate serves as an official document in such cases.

The Certificate is required to be submitted to apply for a duplicate copy to get claims and for other government-related transaction or to prevent any fraud.

In April 2022, then Director General of Police, C. Sylendra Babu, issued a circular listing out various guidelines that should be followed by the petitioner while seeking such a certificate, along with timelines that should be followed by the police department as well.

Many a time, the entire exercise extends for months with various departments including police station in the petitioner's area of jurisdiction, Sub Registrar Office and Central Crime Record Bureau in the picture.

#### Documents to submit

The petitioner is required to furnish certified copies of the documents that are lost (obtained within a month prior to the presentation of the petition at the police station from the Sub Registrar Office concerned). Along with this, a recent photograph of the petitioner, a copy of the Aadhar Card, Voter ID or Passport; and newspaper advertisements placed in an English and a vernacular paper are to be submitted.

In case of death of the legal owner of the property, his or her legal heir should present the petition along with death certificate issued by a local body and legal heir certificate issued by designated Revenue Authority.

An encumbrance certificate for the property in question, for the last 20 years or from the date of registra-

tion of missing document, obtained from the Sub Registrar office, must also be furnished.

The petitioner is also required to submit an undertaking along with the petition that if the missing document is traced later, the Station House Officer (SHO) will be intimated who in turn has to inform the Sub Registrar Office.

Once an application is submitted, the Station House Officer (SHO) issues a CSR to the petitioner.

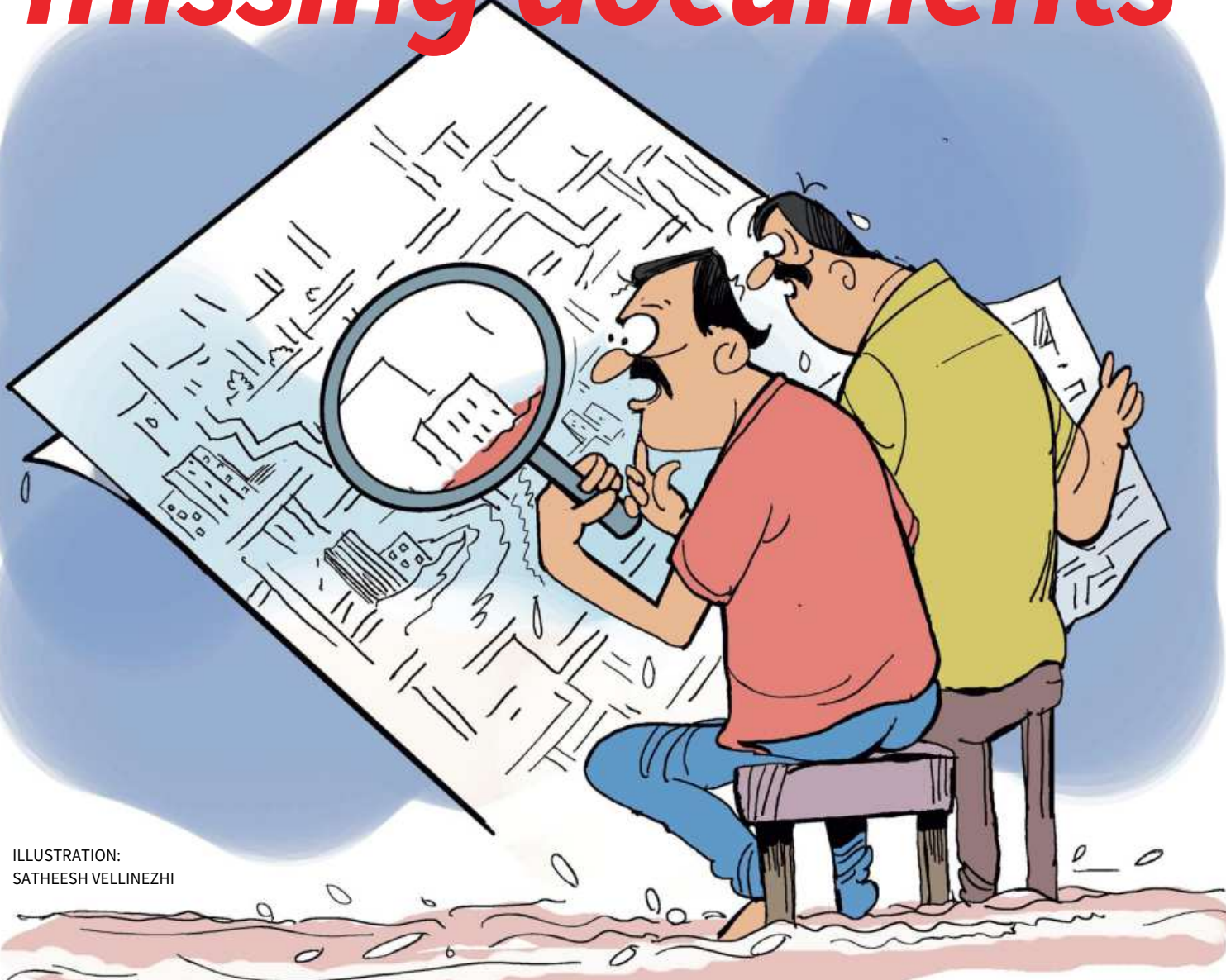
Later, a letter addressed to the Deputy Superintendent of Police/Assistant Commissioner of Police of the DCRB/CCRB is sent informing loss of document along with a certificate.

This is followed by publishing the matter in Crime and Occurrence Sheet within a week from the date of receipt of the letter from the SHO.

The circular insists all police stations to paste it on its notice board and state police website and CCTNS citizen portal to post the circular.

Applications for issuing a Non-Traceable Certificate are also accepted online.

ILLUSTRATION:  
SATHEESH VELLINEZH



## 'A process that consumes time, induces tedium'

C.B. PAUL CHELLAKUMAR

**F**rom my own experience, I can say the procedures involved in getting a Non-Traceable Certificate is tiring, time-consuming and tedious.

I been running around for the last nine months to get the Certificate (CSR No 778 2025) despite producing all supporting documents.

Three officers who were handling my case were transferred and I am back to square one. Now, the new police officers at Thirumangalam Police Station who have taken charge are asking all the documents again as

those filed with the officers are not found. I cite this experience not to meet my ends but to help other petitioners who will be desperately running behind these three agencies, namely the Station House Officer (SHO), Commissioner of Police Office (CPO) and Sub-Registrar's Office (SRO).

The current system must be amended. For instance, the petitioner may be directed to file their petition with the Magistrate Court with all supportive documents, which could then be forwarded to the police station concerned, with proper instructions for action and report within a stipulated time. The magistrate on receipt of the re-

port with all supportive documents can issue the 'Non Traceable Certificate' instead of the SHO doing it.

General information on the procedures and documents required should be made available with every police station. The police personnel at stations are not familiar with the procedures and need proper orientation. The officer should also give acknowledgement for the documents received from the complainant as supportive documents for the loss of property documents also get lost at the police stations.

C.B. Paul Chellakumar is a resident of 13th Main Road, Anna Nagar



# An elusive honour for a freedom fighter

Activists seek to name Chromepet Knowledge Centre after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper; bust awaits official clearance for installation

T. ARVIND

A bust of freedom fighter Parali Su. Nellaiyapper, a close associate of Subramania Bharathi and V.O. Chidambaram Pillai, remains wrapped and awaiting installation at a memorial-cum-library premises in Chromepet, even as activists continue to seek official recognition for his contributions.

The premises, located in Tambaram Corporation's Ward 25, now functions as a Knowledge and Study Centre. Residents and activists have urged the civic body to attach the freedom fighter's name to the renovated facility and formally unveil his bust, which has been ready for installation since March this year.

## Donated land

Parali Su. Nellaiyapper, a poet, philanthropist and freedom fighter, lived in Chromepet during the 1950s. In recognition of his services to the nation, the State government allotted him more than three acres of land in 1954. In 1968, he donated over two grounds of land for establishing a primary school for children from economically weaker sections.

The Parali Su. Nellaiyapper Municipal Primary School functioned for several years before becoming defunct by the late 1990s owing to a shortage of teachers and staff.

Over the years, the premises fell into disrepair, with the abandoned campus turning into a hub for anti-social activities. Residents and activists later initiated efforts to restore the property for public use.

## Campaign for restoration

According to activist S. Meenakshisundaram, efforts to revive the school began in 1996 and gathered momentum after the forma-



tion of the Senior Citizen Welfare Association, Chromepet East, in 2015.

Association members conducted Independence Day and Republic Day celebrations at the premises and campaigned for its restoration. "Cases were filed against us claiming trespassing when we tried to maintain the premises and conduct public events," Meenakshisundaram said.

A major breakthrough came in 2022 when the then Pallavaram Municipality sanctioned ₹1 crore for redevelopment of the site. However, activists opposed proposals to convert the premises into a waste segregation facility or a veterinary clinic, insisting that the land should continue to serve educational purposes in keeping with the freedom fighter's vision.

Following sustained campaigns, including poster protests in 2023 over non-utilisation of funds, the Tambaram Corporation Knowledge and Study Centre was opened in January 2024.



Activist S. Meenakshisundaram points to the pedestal awaiting the installation of freedom fighter's bust at the Knowledge and Study Centre in Chromepet; and (below) Parali Su. Nellaiyapper. PHOTOS: T. ARVIND AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

## Demand for recognition

Activists say the civic body is yet to accept their demand to rename the facility after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper.

"The Knowledge Centre was established on land donated by the freedom fighter. It is only appropriate that the centre bears his name," Meenakshisundaram said.

Efforts were also taken to install a bust of the freedom fighter at the premises. Former MLA E. Karunanidhi contributed around ₹1 lakh towards the in-

itiative, and the bust was sculpted in Mahabalipuram.

However, the installation has reportedly been delayed following disagreements over accommodating another leader's statue at the site. Though the pedestal was widened to house two busts, the second statue is yet to be completed, leaving Parali Su. Nellaiyapper's bust and portrait inside the centre.

Meenakshisundaram recently met Tambaram Corporation Commissioner S. Balachandran and appealed for early clearance to unveil the bust.

## Role in freedom movement

Parali Su. Nellaiyapper worked as an accountant in the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company founded by V.O. Chidambaram Pillai. Activists say he also played a key role in helping Subramania Bharathi relocate to Pudukcherry, then under French rule, to escape British persecution.

He is further remembered for assisting Bharathi's family in conducting the poet's last rites in Triplicane.

At present, nearly 100 students and youth use the Knowledge and Study Centre daily, including for NEET coaching classes. Activists are also planning to seek support from IIT-Madras for donating books to the centre.

Despite years of struggle to restore the premises, activists say their demand remains simple – that the centre be named after Parali Su. Nellaiyapper and that his bust be formally unveiled in honour of his contribution to society and the freedom movement.



# A celebration of inclusion, talent and empowerment



## Samagratha Foundation organises a grand fete to mark its first anniversary

**S**amagratha Foundation celebrated its first anniversary with a grand and emotionally moving musical evening on May 17 at the Mini Hall of The Music Academy, bringing together artists, parents, supporters and children in a celebration of inclusion, talent and empowerment.

Samagratha Foundation offers an inclusive ecosystem where neurodivergent children earn through performances and artistic opportunities, while also helping support neurotypical children from financially weaker backgrounds through educational and music-learning assistance, says a press release.

Over the past year, Samagratha has performed at several prestigious platforms including Riviera at VIT Vellore, Port Day Celebrations



Snapshots of the event held at Music Academy

hosted by Chennai Port Authority, and the 11th Founders Day celebrations of Bank of Baroda. The Foundation was also honoured with the Rota Voices of Victory Award presented by Rotary Club.

V. K. Balamurugan, IRS (retd.), Former Additional Director General - GST Intelligence was the chief

guest. In a press release, the organisers thanked its band ambassador Sujatha Mohan, whose continued encouragement and support have played a significant role in Samagratha's journey from its early days as an inclusive music band to becoming a registered foundation. Other special guests included

Veeramani Raju, devotional singer; Brigadier Suresh Kumar, former Commandant of The Madras Regimental Centre Wellington; Deen, CEO Sathya Agencies; Sandhya Cherian, Director Frontier Lifeline Hospital; Krishnakumar Menon, CEO of Hotel Aadithya; Rajesh Kumar, film producer; Dr. Ravi Narayan, senior neurosurgeon; Umashankar, ghatam maestro and percussionist; and Arul Mozhi, advocate, orator and social influencer

The evening featured heartfelt performances by neurodivergent children of Samagratha, reflecting the organisation's vision of creating an inclusive platform where talent is celebrated beyond labels.

One of the highlights of the evening was a special segment dedicated to mothers, featuring emotional performances by children introduced onto the stage by their parents.

Founders Vinod Venugopal and Reshmi highlighted how Samagratha began as "Samagratha - An Inclusive Crew" on May 7, 2023 and evolved into Samagratha Foundation, a registered Section 8 company committed to inclusion, empowerment, education, awareness, and community impact.

For more details, visit [www.samagratha.com](http://www.samagratha.com)

## Free seminar on metabolic health

Livya Cure Hub and Team High Performance (THP), both based in Alwarpet, jointly launched the 90-day "Advanced Metabolic Reset Programme" recently.

The initiative focusses on 'Metabolic Reset' framework-specifically targeting how it regulates metabolism, controls weight sustainably, and optimises daily energy levels under direct medical supervision rather than relying on generic fitness fads, said a release.

The programme marks the first collaboration between a medical wellness clinic and an on-demand personal fitness brand to combat metabolic issues and lifestyle diseases using preventative healthcare. Over 200 prominent doctors, fitness experts and corporate leaders attended the event, including Dr. V. Sravanthi, Dr. Ashalatha Srinivasan, Livya Cure Hub Managing Director V. K. T. Raju, and THP Founder Hari Prasad, added the release.

For a free, one-hour awareness seminar on 'Metabolic Health and Reset,' hosted weekly at Livya Cure Hub in Alwarpet, call 7200008384 to register.



## Advanced robotic surgery performed

**A**robotic nephrectomy was performed on a three-year-old child using the SSI Mantra 3, a robotic surgical platform at Murugan Hospital, Kilpauk.

The surgery was led by Dr. Raghul M, a paediatric surgeon, along with assistant surgeon Dr. Sabari, and supported by SSI Mantra robotic technician Vishal Pandian. The anesthesia team was headed by Dr. Karthikeyan.

According to a release, the child had been suffering from recurrent urinary tract infections due to a rare congenital urological abnormality - a non-functioning left kidney associated with a grossly dilated and tortuous ectopic ureter draining into the vagina.

Using robotic-assisted minimally invasive surgery, the diseased kidney and abnormal ureter were removed through tiny incisions. The procedure was completed successfully in approximately one hour, with minimal blood loss and excellent intraoperative stability, the release added.

Dr. Raghul said, "Robotic technology is gradually transforming the way complex paediatric surgical procedures are performed. In young children, precision becomes extremely important due to limited working space and delicate anatomical structures."

The hospital is located on Kilpauk Garden Road. Phone: 044 4644 8989.

## Training for students in BFSI sector

M/s. Nunukkam, a skill tech platform, and M/s. We Shine Academy, has signed a Memorandum of Understanding to provide specialised vocational training for students in the Banking, Financial Services and Insurance (BFSI) sector.

The partnership aims to address the growing demand for industry-ready professionals by integrating practical corporate insights with academic foundation, said a release. The collaboration will focus on a multidisciplinary curriculum designed to equip students with technical and soft skills like Banking & Core Finance, Insurance Services, digital financial services and regulatory compliance.

The initiative is expected to benefit over 100 students in its first phase, added the release.

## Best Bargains

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Rotary District 3233 along with a smart educational learning platform is offering a free NEET online test practice series in Tamil and English before the retest on June 21

LIFFY THOMAS

**M**any students have returned to coaching institutes after the National Testing Agency cancelled the NEET 2026 held on May 3 and inked in a retest for June 21. One would be lucky if the institute they have associated with in the last one to two years is only charging a nominal fee or no fee at all for this additional period. For those who cannot afford to get back to the classroom and need some quick help with question banks and test papers, here is a platform that comes free of cost.

QB365, a smart educational learning platform, with the support of Rotary District 3233, has launched a free NEET online test practice series for students in Tamil Nadu.

The initiative aims to help students regain confidence, reduce examination fear, improve exam readiness, and continue their preparation in a positive and structured manner.

According to a press release, Tamil Nadu has one of the highest NEET candidates appearing, with approximately 1.55 lakh students registered for NEET UG 2026. A significant number of students are from rural backgrounds, Tamil-medium schools, and

# A neat solution



Students at a centre in College on May 3. PHOTO. RAGU R

from economically weaker sections who find it difficult to get accessible and affordable academic support.

Purushothaman, a Rotary member and founder of QB365, says they have uploaded 14,000 questions along with answers in all the three subjects in both Tamil and English.

This also includes question papers from previous years and other sample papers based on NCERT syllabus.

He says the platform will be helpful for

students who cannot afford to spend money until the NEET retest but at the same time want to stay updated on what they have learnt. "We are not a coaching institute or tutors but we offer practice exams," he says.

Once a person logs in there are topic wise test papers. A person need to upload their NEET hall ticket to get access to the test papers.

Besides daily and weekly NEET practice tests with mobile-friendly online access, the

platform would also give a performance analysis based on the scores.

Rotarian P. Jayanathan, Chennai coordinator and RI District -Additional Director, says the 30-day course will also offer instant results. Last year, Rotary had a similar tie-up with the educational platform but was charging students a small fee. This year, we are offering it free seeing the stress that students are undergoing with retest and to keep their medical dream alive, says Jayanathan.

At a glance

Website:

[www.qb365.in](http://www.qb365.in)

Key features:

daily and weekly NEET practice tests, topic-wise tests

## PLAN YOUR WEEK

### Guided heritage walk

If you are yet to take a visit to the renovated Victoria Public Hall then do book a slot. The Greater Chennai Corporation has an online booking facility for a guided heritage walk on the premises of Ripon Buildings, near Central Square, for tourists and residents.

Visitors will get to know the history, architecture, and heritage of the place. Individuals, families, schools, colleges, and organisa-



### Handicraft exhibition in Alwarpet

An exhibition-cum-sale organised by Tamilnadu Handicrafts Artisans Welfare Association is happening at Srushti Handicrafts Emporium, Sudarshan Building, Chamiers Road, Alwarpet.

Bronze, brass statues, wood carving, paintings, and many other items are on sale. The sale is on till June 10.

### Happy Foot Reflexology at Alwarpet



Happy Foot Reflexology at Alwarpet provides therapies to relieve stress, improve circulation, and ease tensions. Happy Foot is located on the second floor of a building numbered 32, TTK Road, Demonte Colony, Alwarpet.

The center is open from 10 a.m. to 10 p.m., and can be contacted at 7200405144. Website : <https://happyfootspa.in/>

Dear Readers, write to us about events in your neighbourhood to [downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in](mailto:downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in)

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